on alien technologies. If you want to do anything in rocketry, do it yourself," von Braun advised me. He commented, "SLV-3 is a genuine Indian design and you may be having your own troubles. But you should always remember that we don't just build on successes, we also build on failures."

On the topic of the inevitable hard work that goes with rocket development and the degree of commitment involved, he smiled and said with a glint of mischief in his eyes, "Hard work is not enough in rocketry. It is not a sport where mere hard work can fetch you honours. Here, not only do you have to have a goal but you have to have strategies to achieve it as fast as possible."

"Total commitment is not just hard work, it is total involvement. Building a rock wal is back-breaking work. There are some people who build rock wal s al their lives. And when they die, there are miles of wal s, mute testimonials to how hard those people had worked."

He continued, "But there are other men who while placing one rock on top of another have a vision in their minds, a goal. It may be a terrace with roses climbing over the rock wal s and chairs set out for lazy summer days. Or the rock wal may enclose an apple orchard or mark a